

Notes on GTM-73

May 29, 2026

1 Introduction

Definition 1.1 (Cartesian Product). Let $\{A_i : i \in I\}$ be a family of sets indexed by a nonempty set I . The Cartesian product of the sets A_i is the set of all functions $f : I \rightarrow \bigcup_{i \in I} A_i$ such that $f(i) \in A_i$ for all $i \in I$. It is denoted $\prod_{i \in I} A_i$.

The Axiom of Choice: The product of a family of nonempty sets indexed by a nonempty set is nonempty.

There is another version of the Axiom of Choice.

Theorem 1.1. *Let S be a set. A choice function for S is a function f from the set of all nonempty subsets of S to S such that $f(A) \in A$ for all $A \neq \emptyset$. Then the Axiom of Choice is equivalent to the statement that every S has a choice function.*

Proof. If the A.C. holds, let $\mathcal{P}(S)^*$ be the set of all nonempty subsets of S . Then consider the product $\prod_{A \in \mathcal{P}(S)^*} A$. Since A is nonempty, $\prod_{A \in \mathcal{P}(S)^*} A$ is nonempty. Take $f \in \prod_{A \in \mathcal{P}(S)^*} A$. According to the definition of Cartesian product, $f(A) \in A$, which also satisfies the definition of choice function. Hence every nonempty set S has a choice function.

Suppose $\{X_i\}$ is a family of nonempty sets, let $S = \bigcup_{i \in I} X_i$. Then there is a choice function for S such that $f(A) \in A$ for all $A \neq \emptyset$ and $A \subseteq S$. Note that X_i is also a nonempty set of S . Therefore $f(X_i) \in X_i$ for all $i \in I$. Then define g as $g(i) = f(X_i)$. It is clearly that $g \in \prod_{i \in I} X_i$. Hence $\prod_{i \in I} X_i$ is nonempty. $\square$

Definition 1.2. A **partial ordering** on a set A is a relation R on $A \times A$ satisfies reflexive, transitive and antisymmetric. And A with such a relation is called **partially ordered set**.

Note that two given elements of a partially ordered set need not to be comparable. If any two elements in a partially ordered set is comparable, we call the ordering a linear(or total or simple) ordering.

Here I do not give the specific definition of **maximal**, **upper bound** and **greatest element**. We should note that a maximal element is different from a greatest element. A nonempty subset B of A that is linearly ordered is called a **chain** in A .

Lemma 1.2 (Zorn's lemma). *If A is a nonempty partially ordered set such that every chain in A has an upper bound in A , then A contains a maximal element.*

Definition 1.3 (Well ordered). If every nonempty subset of A has a least element, then A is said to be well ordered.

Every well-ordered set is linearly ordered.

2 Ring

Definition 2.1 (Prime ideal). An ideal P in a ring R is said to be **prime** if $P \neq R$ and for any ideals A, B in R , $AB \subseteq P$ implies $A \subseteq P$ or $B \subseteq P$.

Theorem 2.1. *If P is an ideal in a ring R such that $P \neq R$ and for all $a, b \in R$, $ab \in P \Rightarrow a \in P$ or $b \in P$, then P is prime. Conversely if P is prime and R is commutative, then P satisfies the condition above.*

Consider S to be the ring of all $n \times n$ matrices over a division ring D , $n \geq 2$. Then S has no zero divisors and 0 is a prime ideal which does not satisfies the condition of the theorem above. Thus the commutativity is necessary for the converse of the theorem.

Theorem 2.2. *In a nonzero ring R with identity, maximal (left) ideals always exist. In fact every (left) ideal in R except R itself is contained in a maximal (left) ideal.*

Proof. The proof is application of Zorn's lemma. Note that set theoretic inclusion is a partial order. $\square$

Theorem 2.3. *If R is a commutative ring such that $R^2 = R$ (in particular if R has an identity), then every maximal ideal M in R is prime.*

This theorem provides a sufficient condition for a maximal ideal to be a prime ideal. However, the maximal ideals seem "better" than prime ideals. Is this theorem meaningful?

Theorem 2.4. *Let M be an ideal in a ring R with identity $1_R \neq 0$.*

- (1) *If M is maximal and R is commutative, then the quotient ring R/M is a field.*
- (2) *If the quotient ring R/M is a division ring, then M is a maximal ideal.*

Note the conditions for applying the theorem. (1) is false when R does not have an identity. If M is maximal and R is not commutative, then R/M need not to be a division ring.

Definition 2.2. An element e in a ring R is said to be **idempotent** if $e^2 = e$. An element of the center of the ring R is said to be **central**. Idempotent elements $e_1, e_2, \dots, e_n$ is said to be **orthogonal** if $e_i e_j = 0$ for $i \neq j$.

Theorem 2.5. (*Pierce decomposition*) If e is a central idempotent in a ring R with identity, then $1_R - e$ is a central idempotent. eR and $(1_R - e)R$ are ideals in R such that $R = eR \times (1_R - e)R$.

This decomposition can be generalized to $R = \bigoplus_{i=1}^n \bigoplus_{j=1}^n e_i R e_j$ where $e_1, \dots, e_n$ are idempotent and orthogonal and satisfy $e_1 + e_2 + \dots + e_n = 1$.

Definition 2.3. A nonempty subset S of a ring R is multiplicative provided that $a, b \in S$ implies $ab \in S$.

Theorem 2.6. Let S be a multiplicative subset of a commutative ring R . The relation defined on the set $R \times S$ by

$$(r, s) \sim (r', s') \iff s_1(rs' - r's) = 0 \text{ for some } s_1 \in S$$

is an equivalence relation. Furthermore if R has no zero divisors and $0 \notin S$, then

$$(r, s) \sim (r', s') \iff rs' - r's = 0.$$

The s_1 in this relation aims to satisfy the transitive of equivalence relation.

Let $S^{-1}R$ be the set of equivalence classes of $R \times S$ under the equivalence relation of Theorem 2.6, then we call the ring $S^{-1}R$ (it is easy to verify that $S^{-1}R$ is a ring) the **ring of quotients**. If S is the set of all nonzero elements of an integral domain R , then $S^{-1}R$ is a field called the **quotient field of the integral domain R** (simply quotient field).

Theorem 2.7. Let S be a multiplicative subset of a commutative ring R and let T be any commutative ring with identity. If $f : R \rightarrow T$ is a homomorphism of rings such that $f(s)$ is a unit in T for all $s \in S$, then there exists a unique homomorphism of rings $\bar{f} : S^{-1}R \rightarrow T$ such that $\bar{f}\varphi_S = f$. The ring $S^{-1}R$ is completely determined (up to isomorphism) by this property.

Example 2.1. For instance, let R be the integer ring $\mathbb{Z}$ and S be the evens of $\mathbb{Z}$. Informally speaking, the ring of quotient $S^{-1}R = S^{-1}\mathbb{Z}$ is a ring such that every even is invertible in it. Take $X = \mathbb{Z}[x]_{(2x-1)}$. Then in the ring X , $2n \equiv 1$ for any $n \in \mathbb{Z}$. Thus X is also a ring such that

every even in invertible. The theorem tells that there is a homomorphism between $S^{-1}\mathbb{Z}$ and X . Furthermore, the homomorphism is also an isomorphism, namely $S^{-1}\mathbb{Z} \simeq \mathbb{Z}[x]/(2x-1)$.

Theorem 2.8. *Let S be a multiplicative subset of a commutative ring R with identity. Then there is a one-to-one correspondence between the set of prime ideals of R which are disjoint from S and the set of prime ideals of $S^{-1}R$, given by $P \mapsto S^{-1}P$.*

Definition 2.4. Let R be a commutative ring with identity and P is a prime ideal of R . Then $S = R - P$ is a multiplicative subset of R . The ring of quotients $S^{-1}R$ is called the **localization of R at P** and is denoted as R_P . If I is an ideal in R , then the ideal $S^{-1}I$ in R_P is denoted as I_P .

Theorem 2.9. *Let P be a prime ideal of a commutative ring R with identity. Then*
(1) there is a one-to-one correspondence between the set of prime ideals of R which are contained in P and the set of prime ideals of R_P , given by $Q \mapsto Q_P$;
(2) the ideal P_P in R_P is the unique maximal ideal of R_P .

Definition 2.5. A **local ring** is a commutative ring with identity which has a unique maximal ideal.

Example 2.2. If p is prime and $n \geq 1$, then $\mathbb{Z}_{p^n}$ is a local ring with maximal ideal (p) .

Proof. A commutative ring with identity is a local ring if and only if all nonunits in the ring forms an ideal. Let M be the set of all nonunits in $\mathbb{Z}_{p^n}$, then $M = \{m : p \mid m\}$ since all units in $\mathbb{Z}_{p^n}$ are relatively prime with p and p is prime. Thus $M = \mathbb{Z}_{p^n}p = (p)$. And $M = (p)$ is the unique maximal ideal. $\square$

Theorem 2.10. *If R is a commutative ring with identity then the following conditions are equivalent.*

- (1) R is a local ring;*
- (2) all nonunits of R are contained in some ideal $M \neq R$;*
- (3) the nonunits of R form an ideal.*

Theorem 2.11. *In a commutative ring R with identity the following conditions are equivalent:*

- (1) *R has unique prime ideal;*
- (2) *every nonunit is nilpotent;*
- (3) *R has minimal prime ideal which contains all zero divisors, and all nonunits of R are zero divisors.*

We need a lemma to prove this theorem.

Lemma 2.12. *The set of all nilpotents in R equals to the intersection of all primes ideals of R ,*

$$\text{namely } \text{Nil}(R) = \bigcap_{P \in \text{Spec}(R)} P.$$

The proof of this lemma and theorem can be found in the note of exercises.

3 Module

Theorem 3.1. *Let R be a ring and $A, A_1, A_2, \dots, A_n$ R -modules. Then $A \simeq \bigoplus_{i=1}^n A_i$ if and only if for each $i = 1, 2, \dots, n$ there are R -modules homomorphism $\pi_i : A \rightarrow A_i$ and $\iota_i : A_i \rightarrow A$ such that*

- (i) $\pi_i \iota_i = 1_{A_i}$ for $i = 1, 2, \dots, n$;
- (ii) $\pi_j \iota_i = 0$ for $i \neq j$;
- (iii) $\iota_1 \pi_1 + \iota_2 \pi_2 + \dots + \iota_n \pi_n = 1_A$.

This actually provides a necessary and sufficient condition for the direct sum of $A_1, A_2, \dots, A_n$.

Definition 3.1. A pair of module homomorphism, $A \xrightarrow{f} B \xrightarrow{g} C$, is said to be exact at B provided that $\text{Im } f = \ker g$. A finite sequence of module homomorphisms, $A_0 \xrightarrow{f_1} A_1 \xrightarrow{f_2} A_2 \xrightarrow{f_3} \dots \xrightarrow{f_{n-1}} A_{n-1} \xrightarrow{f_n} A_n$, is exact provided $\text{Im } f_i = \ker f_{i+1}$ for $i = 1, 2, \dots, n-1$. An infinite sequence of module homomorphisms, $\dots \xrightarrow{f_{i-1}} A_{i-1} \xrightarrow{f_i} A_i \xrightarrow{f_{i+1}} A_{i+1} \xrightarrow{f_{i+2}} \dots$ is exact provided $\text{Im } f_i = \ker f_{i+1}$ for all $i \in \mathbb{Z}$.

Definition 3.2. If $f : A \rightarrow B$ is a module homomorphism, then $A/\ker f$ is called the **coimage** of f , $B/\text{Im } f$ is called **cokernel** of f , denoted as $\text{Coim } f$ and $\text{Coker } f$ respectively.

Theorem 3.2. Let R be a ring and $0 \rightarrow A_1 \xrightarrow{f} B \xrightarrow{g} A_2 \rightarrow 0$ a short exact sequence of R -module homomorphisms. Then the short exact sequence is called **split** if it satisfies one of the following conditions:

- (1) there is an R -module homomorphism $h : A_2 \rightarrow B$ such that $gh = \text{id}_{A_2}$;
- (2) there is an R -module homomorphism $k : B \rightarrow A_1$ such that $fk = \text{id}_{A_1}$;
- (3) the given sequence is equivalent to the short exact sequence $0 \rightarrow A_1 \xrightarrow{\iota_1} A_1 \oplus A_2 \xrightarrow{\pi_2} A_2 \rightarrow 0$; in particular $B \simeq A_1 \oplus A_2$.

Theorem 3.3. Let R be a ring with identity. F is called **free R -module** if F satisfies one of the following conditions:

- (1) F has a nonempty basis;
- (2) F is the internal direct sum of a family of cyclic R -modules, each of which is isomorphic as a left R -module to R ;
- (3) F is R -module isomorphic to a direct sum of copies of the left R -module R ;
- (4) there exists a nonempty set X and a function $\iota : X \rightarrow F$ with the following property: given any unitary R -module A and function $f : X \rightarrow A$, there exists a unique R -module homomorphism $\bar{f} : F \rightarrow A$ such that $\bar{f}\iota = f$. In other words, F is a free object in the category of unitary R -modules.

Corollary 3.4. Every (unitary) module A over a ring R (with identity) is the homomorphic image of a free R -module F . If A is finitely generated, then F may be chosen to be finitely generated.

Example 3.1. Take $R = \mathbb{Z}$ and free R -module $F = R^2 = \mathbb{Z}^2 = \{(a, b) : a, b \in \mathbb{Z}\}$.

Then F has a basis $X = \{e_1, e_2\}$, where $e_1 = (1, 0)$ and $e_2 = (0, 1)$.

Let $M_1 = \mathbb{Z}e_1 = \{(a, 0) : a \in \mathbb{Z}\}$, $M_2 = \mathbb{Z}e_2 = \{(0, b) : b \in \mathbb{Z}\}$. Clearly M_1 and M_2 are cyclic R -modules and $M_1 \simeq \mathbb{Z}$, $M_2 \simeq \mathbb{Z}$. Since $M_1 \cap M_2 = \{0\}$ and $M_1 + M_2 = F$, then $F = M_1 \oplus M_2$.

Define $\iota : X \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}^2$ such that $\iota(x_1) = (1, 0)$ and $\iota(x_2) = (0, 1)$. Given an arbitrary $\mathbb{Z}$ -module A and a function $f : X \rightarrow A$, suppose $f(x_1) = a_1$ and $f(x_2) = a_2$. Define $\bar{f} : \mathbb{Z}^2 \rightarrow A$ such that $\bar{f}(m, n) = ma_1 + na_2$ where $m, n \in \mathbb{Z}$. It is easy to verify that $\bar{f}\iota = f$ and since the representation in terms of a basis is unique, the homomorphism $\bar{f}$ is uniquely determined.

Although F may have a basis X who has infinite elements, every element in F can be represented as a finite sum of finite elements in X since F is isomorphic to a direct sum (coproduct) of copies of the

modules.

Generally, we can define free module on any ring which may not have an identity.

Definition 3.3. Let R be any ring and X a nonempty set. An R -module F is called a free module on X if F is a free object on X in the category of all left R -modules.

However, this definition leads to a "bad" result.

Example 3.2. Let R be a ring with identity. Then R is not a free module on any set in the category of all R -modules (as defined in definition 3.3).

Proof. Let A be a nonzero Abelian group with R -module structure $ra = 0$ for any $r \in R$ and $a \in A$. Define $g : X \rightarrow A$ with $g(x_0) = a_0 \neq 0$. Then there exists a unique homomorphism $f : R \rightarrow A$ such that $f\iota = g$. For any r in R , $f(r) = f(r \cdot 1_R) = rf(1_R) = 0$ since $f(1_R) \in A$. Hence g is a zero map, which contradicts to $g(x_0) = a_0 \neq 0$. $\square$

If free module is defined as theorem 3.3 where the ring R has an identity and F is a unitary R -module, R itself could be seen as a left free R -module with rank 1.

Definition 3.4. A module P over a ring R is said to be **projective** if given any diagram of R -modules homomorphisms

$$\begin{array}{ccc} & P & \\ & \downarrow f & \\ A & \xrightarrow{g} & B \longrightarrow 0 \end{array}$$

with bottom row exact, there exists an R -module homomorphism $h : P \rightarrow A$ such that the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} & P & \\ h \swarrow & \downarrow f & \\ A & \xrightarrow{g} & B \longrightarrow 0 \end{array}$$

is commutative (that is, $gh = f$).

Theorem 3.5. Every free module F over a ring R with identity is projective.

Example 3.3. $R = \mathbb{Z}_6$, then $\mathbb{Z}_3$ and $\mathbb{Z}_2$ are $\mathbb{Z}_6$ -modules and it is easy to know that $\mathbb{Z}_6 \simeq \mathbb{Z}_2 \oplus \mathbb{Z}_3$. Hence both $\mathbb{Z}_2$ and $\mathbb{Z}_3$ are projective $\mathbb{Z}_6$ -modules but are not free $\mathbb{Z}_6$ -modules since there are zero divisors in $\mathbb{Z}_6$.

Theorem 3.6. Let R be a ring. The following conditions on an R -module P are equivalent.

- (1) P is projective;
- (2) every short exact sequence $0 \rightarrow A \xrightarrow{f} B \xrightarrow{g} P \rightarrow 0$ is split exact (hence $B \simeq A \oplus P$);
- (3) there is a free module F and an R -module K such that $F \simeq K \oplus P$.

Definition 3.5. A module J over a ring R is said to be **injective** if given any diagram of R -module homomorphisms

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} 0 & \longrightarrow & A & \xrightarrow{g} & B \\ & & f \downarrow & & \\ & & J & & \end{array}$$

with top row exact, there exists an R -module homomorphism $h : B \rightarrow J$ such that the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} 0 & \longrightarrow & A & \xrightarrow{g} & B \\ & & f \downarrow & \swarrow h & \\ & & J & & \end{array}$$

is commutative (that is, $hg = f$).

Theorem 3.7. Let R be a ring.

- (1) A direct sum of R -modules $\sum_{i \in I} P_i$ is projective iff each P_i is projective;
- (2) A direct product of R -modules $\prod_{i \in I} J_i$ is injective iff each J_i is injective.

Theorem 3.8 (Baer Criterion). Let R be a ring with identity. A unitary R -module J is injective iff for every left ideal L of R , any R -module homomorphism $L \rightarrow J$ may be extended to an R -module homomorphism $R \rightarrow J$.

Theorem 3.9. Let R be a ring with identity. The following conditions on a unitary R -module J are equivalent.

- (1) J is injective;
- (2) every short exact sequence $0 \rightarrow J \xrightarrow{f} B \xrightarrow{g} C \rightarrow 0$ is split exact (hence $B \simeq J \oplus C$);
- (3) J is a direct summand of any module B of which it is a submodule.

Proof. The detailed proof can be found in textbook. □

Remark 3.1. (1) This theorem still holds without the identity. However, since both Baer's criterion and the existence of injective embeddings require the ring to be unital ring and the module to be unitary, the proof of theorem 3.9 is provided only for this case to ensure simplicity and utility.

(2) Note that theorem 3.6(3) states that a projective module is a direct summand of some free module, whereas theorem 3.9(3) claims that an injective module is a direct summand of any module containing it.

Example 3.4. $\mathbb{Q}$ is not a projective $\mathbb{Z}$ -module.

Proof. □

Is $\mathbb{Q}$ a projective $\mathbb{Q}$ -module? The answer is yes since it is actually a vector space over a division ring, hence a free module.

Projective and injective modules are dual to each other. Is there, then, a concept dual to free modules? The following theorem addresses this question.

Theorem 3.10. *An R -module F is co-free on a set X if there exists a function $\iota : F \rightarrow X$ such that for any R -module A and function $f : A \rightarrow X$, there exists a unique module homomorphism $\bar{f} : A \rightarrow F$ such that $\iota\bar{f} = f$. Then for any set X with $|X| \geq 2$ no such R -module F exists. If $|X| = 1$, then 0 is the only co-free module.*

Proof. Assume F is co-free on a set X with $|X| \geq 2$. Since $\bar{f} : A \rightarrow F$ is a homomorphism, then $\iota\bar{f}(0_A) = \iota(0_F) = f(0_A)$. Note that f is an arbitrary function, then $\forall x \in X$, there exists $f : A \rightarrow X$ such that $f(0_A) = x$. But the function ι is fixed whence $\iota(0_F)$ is fixed. That is a contradiction.

If $|X| = 1$, take $A = F$ then $\iota(k) = x, f(a) = x, \forall a \in A, k \in F$. Then for any homomorphism $\bar{f} : F \rightarrow F$, $\iota\bar{f} = f$ holds. In particular, when $\bar{f} = \text{id}_F, 0, \iota\bar{f} = f$. Since $\bar{f}$ is unique, then $\text{id}_F(k) = 0(k) = 0 \Rightarrow k = 0, \forall k \in F$. Hence F is 0 module. □

If A, B are modules over a ring R , then $\text{Hom}_R(A, B)$ is the set of all R -modules homomorphisms $f : A \rightarrow B$ and $\text{Hom}_R(A, B)$ is an abelian group under addition and this addition is distributive with respect to composition of functions.

Theorem 3.11. *Let A, B, C, D be modules over a ring R and $\varphi : C \rightarrow A$ and $\psi : B \rightarrow D$ R -module homomorphism. Then the map $\theta : \text{Hom}_R(A, B) \rightarrow \text{Hom}_R(C, D)$ given by $f \mapsto \psi f \varphi$ is a homomorphism of abelian groups.*

The map θ is usually denoted $\text{Hom}(\varphi, \psi)$ and called the homomorphism induced by φ and ψ .

Theorem 3.12. Let R be a ring. $0 \rightarrow A \xrightarrow{\varphi} B \xrightarrow{\psi} C$ is an exact sequence of R -modules iff for every R -module D

$$0 \rightarrow \operatorname{Hom}_R(D, A) \xrightarrow{\bar{\varphi}} \operatorname{Hom}_R(D, B) \xrightarrow{\bar{\psi}} \operatorname{Hom}_R(D, C)$$

is an exact sequence of abelian groups.

Theorem 3.13. Let R be a ring. $A \xrightarrow{\theta} B \xrightarrow{\zeta} C \rightarrow 0$ is an exact sequence of R -modules iff for every R -module D

$$0 \rightarrow \operatorname{Hom}_R(C, D) \xrightarrow{\bar{\zeta}} \operatorname{Hom}_R(B, D) \xrightarrow{\bar{\theta}} \operatorname{Hom}_R(A, D)$$

is an exact sequence of abelian groups.

By preceding results we say $\operatorname{Hom}_R(A, B)$ to be **left exact**. It is not true in general that a short sequence $0 \rightarrow A \rightarrow B \rightarrow C \rightarrow 0$ induces a short exact sequence $0 \rightarrow \operatorname{Hom}_R(D, A) \rightarrow \operatorname{Hom}_R(D, B) \rightarrow \operatorname{Hom}_R(D, C) \rightarrow 0$ or $0 \rightarrow \operatorname{Hom}_R(C, D) \rightarrow \operatorname{Hom}_R(B, D) \rightarrow \operatorname{Hom}_R(A, D) \rightarrow 0$.

Example 3.5. Consider $0 \rightarrow \mathbb{Z} \xrightarrow{f} \mathbb{Z} \xrightarrow{g} \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z} \rightarrow 0$ where $f(x) = 2x$ and g is canonical projection. Take $D = \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$, then $\operatorname{Hom}(D, \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}) \simeq \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$ since homomorphism maps 0 to 0, and $\operatorname{Hom}(D, \mathbb{Z})$ is zero since the order of the elements in D is 2 while there is no element in $\mathbb{Z}$ with order 2. The induced sequence $0 \rightarrow 0 \xrightarrow{\bar{f}} 0 \xrightarrow{\bar{g}} \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z} \rightarrow 0$ is not an exact sequence since the map $\bar{g}$ is not an epimorphism.

Take $D = \mathbb{Z}$, then $\operatorname{Hom}(\mathbb{Z}, D) \simeq \mathbb{Z}$ since the homomorphism is determined by the identity in $\mathbb{Z}$, and $\operatorname{Hom}(\mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}, D)$ is zero. The induced sequence $0 \rightarrow 0 \xrightarrow{\bar{g}} \mathbb{Z} \xrightarrow{\bar{f}} \mathbb{Z} \rightarrow 0$ is not an exact sequence. In fact, $\bar{f}(\varphi) = \varphi f$ where $\varphi \in \operatorname{Hom}(\mathbb{Z}, \mathbb{Z})$ and $f(x) = 2x$, hence $\bar{f}$ could not be an epimorphism.

However, in some cases the exactness still holds in the induced sequence.

Theorem 3.14. The following conditions on modules over a ring R are equivalent.

- (1) $0 \rightarrow A \xrightarrow{\varphi} B \xrightarrow{\psi} C \rightarrow 0$ is a split exact sequence of R -module;
- (2) $0 \rightarrow \operatorname{Hom}_R(D, A) \xrightarrow{\bar{\varphi}} \operatorname{Hom}_R(D, B) \xrightarrow{\bar{\psi}} \operatorname{Hom}_R(D, C) \rightarrow 0$ is a split exact sequence of abelian groups for every R -module D ;
- (3) $0 \rightarrow \operatorname{Hom}_R(C, D) \xrightarrow{\bar{\psi}} \operatorname{Hom}_R(B, D) \xrightarrow{\bar{\varphi}} \operatorname{Hom}_R(A, D) \rightarrow 0$ is a split exact sequence of abelian groups for every R -module D .

Corollary 3.15. *The following conditions on a module P over a ring R are equivalent.*

- (1) P is projective;
- (2) if $\psi : B \rightarrow C$ is any R -module epimorphism, then $\bar{\psi} : \text{Hom}_R(P, B) \rightarrow \text{Hom}_R(P, C)$ is an epimorphism of abelian group;
- (3) if $0 \rightarrow A \xrightarrow{\varphi} B \xrightarrow{\psi} C \rightarrow 0$ is any short exact sequence of R -modules, then $0 \rightarrow \text{Hom}_R(P, A) \xrightarrow{\bar{\varphi}} \text{Hom}_R(P, B) \xrightarrow{\bar{\psi}} \text{Hom}_R(P, C) \rightarrow 0$ is an exact sequence of abelian groups.

Corollary 3.16. *The following conditions on a module J over a ring R are equivalent.*

- (1) J is injective;
- (2) if $\theta : A \rightarrow B$ is any R -module monomorphism, then $\bar{\theta} : \text{Hom}_R(B, J) \rightarrow \text{Hom}_R(A, J)$ is an epimorphism of abelian group;
- (3) if $0 \rightarrow A \xrightarrow{\theta} B \xrightarrow{\zeta} C \rightarrow 0$ is any short exact sequence of R -modules, then $0 \rightarrow \text{Hom}_R(C, J) \xrightarrow{\bar{\zeta}} \text{Hom}_R(B, J) \xrightarrow{\bar{\theta}} \text{Hom}_R(A, J) \rightarrow 0$ is an exact sequence of abelian groups.

Intuitively, Hom functors are only left-exact and lose surjectivity at the right end. A projective module "repairs" this for the covariant functor via its lifting property, while an injective module "repairs" this for the contravariant functor (which reverses arrows) via its extending property.

Theorem 3.17. *Let $A, B, \{A_i : i \in I\}$ and $\{B_j : j \in J\}$ be modules over a ring R . Then there are isomorphisms of abelian groups:*

- (1) $\text{Hom}_R\left(\bigoplus_{i \in I} A_i, B\right) \simeq \prod_{i \in I} \text{Hom}_R(A_i, B);$
- (2) $\text{Hom}_R\left(A, \prod_{j \in J} B_j\right) \simeq \prod_{j \in J} \text{Hom}_R(A, B_j).$

Example 3.6. Let R^n and R^m be free modules of rank n and m respectively, then $R^n = \bigoplus_{j=1}^n R$ and $R^m = \prod_{i=1}^m R$ since products and coproducts are isomorphic under finite modules. By the theorem above,

$$\text{Hom}_R\left(\bigoplus_{j=1}^n R, R^m\right) \simeq \prod_{j=1}^n \text{Hom}_R(R, R^m) \simeq \prod_{j=1}^n \prod_{i=1}^m \text{Hom}_R(R, R) \simeq \prod_{j=1}^n \left(\prod_{i=1}^m R\right).$$

This corresponds to the matrix of $m \times n$ on R .

Since $\text{Hom}_R(A, B)$ forms an abelian group not a module, we need consider possible module structures on it.

Let R and S be rings. An abelian group A is said to be an R - S **bimodule** provided that A is both

a left R -module and a right S -module and $r(as) = (ra)s$ for all $a \in A, r \in R, s \in S$, denoted as ${}_RA_S$.

Theorem 3.18. *Let R and S be rings and let ${}_RA, {}_RB_S, {}_RC_S, {}_RD$ be (bi)modules as indicated.*

(i) $\text{Hom}_R(A, B)$ is a right S -module, with the action of S given by $(fs)(a) = (f(a))s, s \in S, a \in A, f \in \text{Hom}_R(A, B)$.

(ii) If $\varphi : A \rightarrow A'$ is a homomorphism of left R -modules, then the induced map $\bar{\varphi} : \text{Hom}_R(A', B) \rightarrow \text{Hom}_R(A, B)$ is a homomorphism of right S -modules.

(iii) $\text{Hom}_R(C, D)$ is a left S -module, with the action of S given by $(sg)(c) = g(cs), s \in S, c \in C, g \in \text{Hom}_R(C, D)$.

(iv) If $\psi : D \rightarrow D'$ is a homomorphism of left R -module, then $\bar{\psi} : \text{Hom}_R(C, D) \rightarrow \text{Hom}_R(C, D')$ is a homomorphism of left S -modules.

Theorem 3.19. *If A is a unitary left module over a ring R with identity, then there is an isomorphism of left R -modules $A \simeq \text{Hom}_R(R, A)$.*

Through this theorem, we can easily prove that a ring R with identity is projective as a R -module.

Corollary 3.20. *A ring R with identity is projective as a left R -module.*

Proof. Given a short exact sequence $0 \rightarrow A \xrightarrow{\varphi} B \xrightarrow{\psi} C \rightarrow 0$ of R -modules, if $0 \rightarrow \text{Hom}_R(R, A) \xrightarrow{\bar{\varphi}} \text{Hom}_R(R, B) \xrightarrow{\bar{\psi}} \text{Hom}_R(R, C) \rightarrow 0$ is also an exact sequence then R is projective by Corollary 3.15.

By Theorem 3.19, $\text{Hom}_R(R, X) \simeq X, X = A, B, C$. Clearly $\text{Hom}_R(R, -)$ keeps the exactness of the sequence (the diagram is commutative). Thus R is projective. $\square$

Definition 3.6. Let A be a left module over a ring R , then $\text{Hom}_R(A, R)$ is a right R -module and is called the **dual** module of A , denoted as A^* .

Theorem 3.21. *Let A, B, C be left modules over a ring R .*

(i) If $\varphi : A \rightarrow C$ is a homomorphism of left R -modules, then the induced map $\bar{\varphi} : C^* = \text{Hom}_R(C, R) \rightarrow \text{Hom}_R(A, R) = A^*$ is a homomorphism of right R -module.

(ii) There is an R -module isomorphism $(A \oplus C)^* \simeq A^* \oplus C^*$.

(iii) If R is a division ring and $0 \rightarrow A \xrightarrow{\theta} B \xrightarrow{\zeta} C \rightarrow 0$ is a short exact sequence of left vector spaces, then $0 \rightarrow C^* \xrightarrow{\bar{\zeta}} B^* \xrightarrow{\bar{\theta}} A^* \rightarrow 0$ is a short exact sequence of right vector spaces.

The map $\bar{\varphi}$ is called the **dual map** of φ .

Theorem 3.22. Let F be a free module over a ring R with identity. Let X be a basis of F and for each $x \in X$ let $f_x : F \rightarrow R$ be given by $f_x(y) = \delta_{xy}$. Then

(i) $\{f_x : x \in X\}$ is a linearly independent subset of F^* of cardinality $|X|$;

(ii) if X is finite, then F^* is a free right R -module with basis $\{f_x : x \in X\}$.

The process of forming duals may be repeated. If A is a left R -module, then A^* is a right R -module and $A^{**} = (A^*)^* = \text{Hom}_R(\text{Hom}_R(A, R), R)$ is a left R -module. A^{**} is called the double dual of A .

Theorem 3.23. Let A be a left module over a ring R .

(i) There is an R -module homomorphism $\theta : A \rightarrow A^{**}$.

(ii) If R has an identity and A is free, then θ is a monomorphism.

(iii) If R has an identity and A is free with a finite basis, then θ is an isomorphism.

A module A such that $\theta : A \rightarrow A^{**}$ is an isomorphism is said to be **reflexive**.

Example 3.7. The theorem above without the condition that A has a finite basis does not hold.

Let $F = \bigoplus_{x \in X} \mathbb{Z}x$ be a free $\mathbb{Z}$ -module with an infinite basis X . Then $\{f_x : x \in X\}$ does not form a basis of F^* .

Proof. Note that $F^* = \text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(F, \mathbb{Z}) = \text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(\bigoplus_{x \in X} \mathbb{Z}x, \mathbb{Z}) \simeq \prod_{x \in X} \text{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(\mathbb{Z}x, \mathbb{Z}) \simeq \prod_{x \in X} \mathbb{Z}x$ which is a direct product, not a direct sum. $\square$

Definition 3.7. Let A_R and ${}_R B$ be modules over a ring R and C be an additive abelian group, then a **middle linear map** from $A \times B$ to C is a function $f : A \times B \rightarrow C$ such that for all $a, a_i \in A, b, b_i \in B$ and $r \in R$:

$$f(a_1 + a_2, b) = f(a_1, b) + f(a_2, b)$$

$$f(a, b_1 + b_2) = f(a, b_1) + f(a, b_2)$$

$$f(ar, b) = f(a, rb).$$

Definition 3.8. Let A be a right module and B a left module over a ring R . Let F be the free abelian group on the set $A \times B$. Let K be the subgroup of F generated by all elements of the following forms (for all $a, a' \in A; b, b' \in B; r \in R$):

(i) $(a + a', b) - (a, b) - (a', b)$;

(ii) $(a, b + b') - (a, b) - (a, b')$;

(iii) $(ar, b) - (a, rb)$.

The quotient group F/K is called the **tensor product** of A and B ; it is denoted $A \otimes_R B$ (or simply $A \otimes B$ if $R = \mathbb{Z}$). The coset $(a, b) + K$ of the element (a, b) in F is denoted $a \otimes b$; the coset of $(0, 0)$ is denoted 0.

The element of $A \otimes_R B$ usually is of the form $\sum_{i=1}^r n_i(a_i \otimes b_i)$ and note that the tensor product is the coset of F/K hence may have different representatives. Also by definition, for all $a, a_i \in A$, $b, b_i \in B$, and $r \in R$, there follows:

$$(a_1 + a_2) \otimes b = a_1 \otimes b + a_2 \otimes b;$$

$$a \otimes (b_1 + b_2) = a \otimes b_1 + a \otimes b_2;$$

$$ar \otimes b = a \otimes rb.$$

Given modules A_R and ${}_R B$ over a ring R , it is easy to verify that the map $i : A \times B \rightarrow A \otimes_R B$ given by $(a, b) \mapsto a \otimes b$ is a middle linear map. The map i is called the **canonical middle linear map**.

Theorem 3.24. *Let A_R and ${}_R B$ be modules over a ring R , and let C be an abelian group. If $g : A \times B \rightarrow C$ is a middle linear map, then there exists a unique group homomorphism $\bar{g} : A \otimes_R B \rightarrow C$ such that $\bar{g}i = g$, where $i : A \times B \rightarrow A \otimes_R B$ is the canonical middle linear map. $A \otimes_R B$ is uniquely determined up to isomorphism by this property. In other words $i : A \times B \rightarrow A \otimes_R B$ is universal in the category $\mathfrak{M}(A, B)$ of all middle linear map on $A \times B$.*

Theorem 3.25. *If $A \xrightarrow{f} B \xrightarrow{g} C \rightarrow 0$ is an exact sequence of left modules over a ring R and D is a right R -module, then*

$$D \otimes_R A \xrightarrow{1_D \otimes f} D \otimes_R B \xrightarrow{1_D \otimes g} D \otimes_R C \rightarrow 0$$

is an exact sequence of abelian groups. An analogous statement holds for an exact sequence in the first variable.

The tensor product preserves surjections. If $h : A_R \rightarrow A'_R$ and $k : {}_R B \rightarrow {}_R B'$ are module epimorphisms, then by Theorem 3.25, $h \otimes k : A \otimes_R B \rightarrow A' \otimes_R B'$ is an epimorphism since $h \otimes k = (1_{A'} \otimes k)(h \otimes 1_B)$. However, if h and k are monomorphisms, $1_{A'} \otimes k$ and $h \otimes 1_B$ need not to be monomorphisms.

Example 3.8. The usual injection $\alpha : \mathbb{Z}_2 \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}_4$ is a monomorphism of abelian group. But the map $1 \otimes \alpha : \mathbb{Z}_2 \otimes \mathbb{Z}_2 \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}_2 \otimes \mathbb{Z}_4$ is the zero map.

Proof. Since α is a homomorphism, then $\alpha(x) = 2x, x = \bar{0}, \bar{1}$. Thus $(1 \otimes \alpha)(a \otimes b) = a \otimes 2b$ where $a, b = \bar{0}, \bar{1}$. Since $0 = 2 \cdot 0$, then $1 \otimes \alpha$ is the zero map. $\square$

Theorem 3.26. Let R and S be rings and ${}_S A_R, {}_R B, C_R, {}_R D_S$ (bi)modules as indicated.

- (i) $A \otimes_R B$ is a left S -module such that $s(a \otimes b) = sa \otimes b$ for all $s \in S, a \in A, b \in B$.
- (ii) If $f : A \rightarrow A'$ is a homomorphism of $S - R$ bimodules and $g : B \rightarrow B'$ is an R -module homomorphism, then the induced map $f \otimes g : A \otimes_R B \rightarrow A' \otimes_R B'$ is a homomorphism of left S -modules.
- (iii) $C \otimes_R D$ is a right S -module such that $(c \otimes d)s = c \otimes ds$ for all $c \in C, d \in D, s \in S$.
- (iv) If $h : C \rightarrow C'$ is an R -module homomorphism and $k : D \rightarrow D'$ a homomorphism of $R - S$ bimodules, then the induce map $h \otimes k : C \otimes_R D \rightarrow C' \otimes_R D'$ is a homomorphism of right S -module.

If R is a commutative ring, then the tensor product of R -module may be characterized by a useful variation. Let A, B, C be modules over a commutative ring R . A **bilinear map** from $A \times B$ to C is a function $f : A \times B \rightarrow C$ such that for all $a, a_i \in A, b, b_i \in B$, and $r \in R$:

$$f(a_1 + a_2, b) = f(a_1, b) + f(a_2, b)$$

$$f(a, b_1 + b_2) = f(a, b_1) + f(a, b_2)$$

$$f(ra, b) = f(a, rb) = rf(a, b).$$

If A and B are modules over a commutative ring R , then so is $A \otimes_R B$ and the canonical middle linear map $i : A \times B \rightarrow A \otimes_R B$ is easily seen to be bilinear. In this context i is called the **canonical bilinear map**.

Theorem 3.27. If A, B, C are modules over a commutative ring R and $g : A \times B \rightarrow C$ is a bilinear map, then there is a unique R -module homomorphism $\bar{g} : A \otimes_R B \rightarrow C$ such that $\bar{g}i = g$, where $i : A \times B \rightarrow A \otimes_R B$ is the canonical bilinear map. The module $A \otimes_R B$ is uniquely determined up to isomorphism by this property.

Theorem 3.28. If R is a ring with identity and $A_R, {}_R B$ are unitary R -modules, then there are R -module isomorphisms

$$A \otimes_R R \simeq A \quad \text{and} \quad R \otimes_R B \simeq B.$$

Theorem 3.29. If R and S are rings and $A_R, {}_R B_S, {}_S C$ are (bi)modules, then there is an isomorphism

$$(A \otimes_R B) \otimes_S C \simeq A \otimes_R (B \otimes_S C).$$

Proof. Fix $c \in C$ and define $f_c : A \times B \rightarrow A \otimes_R (B \otimes_S C)$ such that $f_c(a, b) = a \otimes (b \otimes c)$. Then $f_c(ar, b) = (ar) \otimes (b \otimes c) = a \otimes r(b \otimes c) = a \otimes (rb \otimes c) = f_c(a, rb)$. Thus there exists a unique group homomorphism $\varphi_c : A \otimes_R B \rightarrow A \otimes_R (B \otimes_S C)$.

Define $g : (A \otimes_R B) \times C \rightarrow A \otimes_R (B \otimes_S C)$ such that $g(x, c) = \varphi_c(x)$ where $x \in A \otimes_R B$. Then for $x = a \otimes b$, $g(xs, c) = \varphi_c(xs) = \varphi_c((a \otimes b)s) = \varphi_c(a \otimes bs) = a \otimes (bs \otimes c) = a \otimes (b \otimes sc) = \varphi_{sc}(x) = g(x, sc)$. Hence there exists a unique group homomorphism $\phi : (A \otimes_R B) \otimes_S C \rightarrow A \otimes_R (B \otimes_S C)$ such that $\phi((a \otimes b) \otimes c) = a \otimes (b \otimes c)$.

Symmetrically we can construct the inverse map $\psi : A \otimes_R (B \otimes_S C) \rightarrow (A \otimes_R B) \otimes_S C$ such that $\psi(a \otimes (b \otimes c)) = (a \otimes b) \otimes c$. Note that $\phi\psi = \text{id}$ and $\psi\phi = \text{id}$. Hence $(A \otimes_R B) \otimes_S C \simeq A \otimes_R (B \otimes_S C)$. $\square$

Theorem 3.30. Let R be a ring, A and $\{A_i : i \in I\}$ right R -modules, B and $\{B_j : j \in J\}$ left R -modules. Then there are group isomorphism.

$$\begin{aligned} \left(\bigoplus_{i \in I} A_i \right) \otimes_R B &\simeq \bigoplus_{i \in I} (A_i \otimes_R B); \\ A \otimes_R \left(\bigoplus_{j \in J} B_j \right) &\simeq \bigoplus_{j \in J} (A \otimes_R B_j). \end{aligned}$$

Proof.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \left(\bigoplus_{i \in I} A_i \right) \times B & \xrightarrow{f} & \bigoplus_{i \in I} (A_i \otimes_R B) \\ \downarrow i & \nearrow \varphi & \\ \left(\bigoplus_{i \in I} A_i \right) \otimes_R B & & \\ \\ A_i \times B & \xrightarrow{\psi_i} & \left(\bigoplus_{i \in I} A_i \right) \otimes_R B \\ \downarrow i_2 & & \parallel \\ A_i \otimes_R B & \xrightarrow{\bar{\psi}_i} & \left(\bigoplus_{i \in I} A_i \right) \otimes_R B \\ \downarrow \iota_i & \nearrow \psi & \\ \bigoplus_{i \in I} (A_i \otimes_R B) & & \end{array}$$

$\varphi\psi = \text{id}, \psi\varphi = \text{id}$. $\square$

Theorem 3.31 (Adjoint Associativity). Let R and S be rings and $A_R, {}_R B_S, C_S$ (bi)modules. Then there is an isomorphism of abelian groups

$$\alpha : \text{Hom}_S(A \otimes_R B, C) \simeq \text{Hom}_R(A, \text{Hom}_S(B, C)),$$

defined for each $f : A \otimes_R B \rightarrow C$ by

$$[(\alpha f)(a)](b) = f(a \otimes b).$$

Proof. For all $a, a_i \in A, b, b_i \in B, f, f_i \in \text{Hom}_S(A \otimes_R B, C), r \in R, s \in S$, we need to check that $(\alpha(f))(a)$ is a S -module homomorphism, $\alpha(f)$ is an R -module homomorphism and α is a group homomorphism in turn.

$$\begin{aligned} ((\alpha f)(a))(b_1 + b_2) &= f(a \otimes (b_1 + b_2)) = f(a \otimes b_1 + a \otimes b_2) \\ &= f(a \otimes b_1) + f(a \otimes b_2) = ((\alpha f)(a))(b_1) + ((\alpha f)(a))(b_2), \\ ((\alpha f)(a))(bs) &= f(a \otimes bs) = f((a \otimes b)s) = f(a \otimes b)s = ((\alpha f)(a))(b)s. \end{aligned}$$

Hence $(\alpha f)(a)$ is a S -module homomorphism.

$$\begin{aligned} ((\alpha f)(a_1 + a_2))(b) &= f((a_1 + a_2) \otimes b) = f(a_1 \otimes b) + f(a_2 \otimes b) = ((\alpha f)(a_1))(b) + ((\alpha f)(a_2))(b), \\ ((\alpha f)(ar))(b) &= f(ar \otimes b) = f(a \otimes rb) = ((\alpha f)(a))(rb) = [(\alpha f)(a) \cdot r](b). \end{aligned}$$

Hence αf is an R -module homomorphism.

$$(\alpha(f_1 + f_2)(a))(b) = (f_1 + f_2)(a \otimes b) = f_1(a \otimes b) + f_2(a \otimes b) = ((\alpha f_1)(a))(b) + ((\alpha f_2)(a))(b),$$

thus α is a group homomorphism.

Now we need to find its inverse map $\beta : \text{Hom}_R(A, \text{Hom}_S(B, C)) \rightarrow \text{Hom}_S(A \otimes_R B, C)$. Note that for all $g \in \text{Hom}_R(A, \text{Hom}_S(B, C))$, there is $\beta g \in \text{Hom}_S(A \otimes_R B, C)$ and βg is a map from a tensor product to a set. Thus we first define $\psi : A \times B \rightarrow C$ such that $\psi(a, b) = (g(a))(b)$. Since $A \times B$ is Descartes product and $g \in \text{Hom}_S(A \otimes_R B, C)$, then easily ψ is well-defined.

$$\begin{aligned} \psi(a_1 + a_2, b) &= (g(a_1 + a_2))(b) = (g(a_1))(b) + (g(a_2))(b) = \psi(a_1, b) + \psi(a_2, b), \\ \psi(a, b_1 + b_2) &= (g(a))(b_1 + b_2) = (g(a))(b_1) + (g(a))(b_2) = \psi(a, b_1) + \psi(a, b_2), \\ \psi(ar, b) &= (g(ar))(b) = (g(a)r)(b) = (g(a))(rb) = \psi(a, rb). \end{aligned}$$

Hence ψ is a middle linear map and there exists a unique group homomorphism $\beta g : A \otimes_R B \rightarrow C$ such that $(\beta g)(a \otimes b) = (g(a))(b)$.

$$(\beta g)((a \otimes b)s) = (\beta g)(a \otimes bs) = (g(a))(bs) = (g(a))(b) \cdot s = (\beta g)(a \otimes b)s,$$

thus βg is also a S -module homomorphism.

For all $g_1, g_2 \in \text{Hom}_S(A \otimes_R B, C)$, there is

$$(\beta(g_1 + g_2))(a \otimes b) = ((g_1 + g_2)(a))(b) = (g_1(a))(b) + (g_2(a))(b) = (\beta g_1)(a \otimes b) + (\beta g_2)(a \otimes b).$$

Hence β is a group homomorphism. Then $[(\alpha(\beta g))(a)](b) = (\beta g)(a \otimes b) = (g(a))(b)$ implies $\alpha(\beta g) =$

$(\alpha\beta)g = g$ and $(\beta(\alpha f))(a \otimes b) = ((\alpha f)(a))(b) = f(a \otimes b)$ implies $\beta(\alpha f) = (\beta\alpha)f = f$. Hence α is a group isomorphism and $\text{Hom}_S(A \otimes_R B, C) \simeq \text{Hom}_R(A, \text{Hom}_S(B, C))$. $\square$